

NICK RIOS

PRINCIPAL ENGINEER

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Principal engineer and team lead with 20 years building platforms at enterprise scale — and five years shipping production AI systems before it was fashionable. Led local and offshore teams at Cisco and Digital Harbor, launched an AI agent platform powering 100+ services, and consistently delivers working systems. Based in Austin, TX. Seeking a role with meaningful influence over product direction.

CORE SKILLS

AI & LLM Systems	Built agent platforms, RAG pipelines, and natural-language UI generation. 100+ production AI services. Including code reviewers integrated with Gitlab and Teams.
Full-Stack Product Delivery	Node/TypeScript, Angular, Elasticsearch, Neo4j. Takes products from concept to production, end to end. Deep PHP history.
Systems & Architecture	Multi-tenant platforms and high-volume ingestion. Designs durable API contracts teams build on for years. Evangelist for declarative model first design.
Front-end Designs	Built thousands of pixel-perfect pages in every major framework and vanilla, long before AI existed. Builds robust, reactive, performant front-end pipelines.
Leadership	Leads local and offshore teams. Designed hiring processes, ran scrum, aligned stakeholders through demos. Participated and hosted Lunch and Learns.
Daily AI Practice	Works daily in Cursor, OpenAI Codex, Antigravity, and Claude. Runs local LLMs, voice cloning, and music generation on Ollama — open source models, testing new GitHub projects on the edge.

EXPERIENCE

Digital Harbor — Team Lead & AI Developer

Sep 2020 – Mar 2025

Earned team lead over three initiatives through delivery. A relentless idea promoter in a company that ran on brainstorming; led an innovation track that became the AI innovation team. Selected for company-wide leadership retreat.

- Made core contributions to Set-Forms across the builder and server layers
- Delivered templating, theming, chat, and next-gen forms — before the AI era began
- Championed the ui-style-library that unified multiple Angular teams, cutting time-to-production 80%
- Once AI landed, pivoted to HTML generation and AI-powered WYSIWYG — live UI from LLM command schemas
- Conceived and built the AI agent management and rapid API deployment platform that became the backbone of 100+ services spanning chat, content, design, and automation. Hosted weekly AI innovation call
- Built the image API adopted company-wide, integrating media providers for simple consumption
- Designed RAG pipelines for structured and unstructured data, with and without LangChain
- Put an AI code reviewer on every GitLab check-in, pushing diff-based reviews to Teams
- Stabilized failing products through simplification and refactoring
- Consistently led my teams' demos and business-ideas; ran cross-team sessions and new-hire onboarding

Took an enterprise alerting and ticketing platform from internal launch to public release — earning multiple team leadership positions along the way. A data-science and performance shop at heart: UI patterns so optimized the team spent its time on data transformations, not pixels.

- Solved multi-source data ingestion into a single Elasticsearch source of truth
- Launched Neo4j at enterprise scale; its founders flew to Austin to meet the team after signup
- Key part of the Splunk rollout — my team owned the top-level single pane of glass
- Won a global innovation award at all-hands; demoed the product live to 4,000+ viewers including SVPs
- Primary interface between engineering, product, design, and stakeholders; influenced roadmap
- Led local and offshore teams; scaled high-volume event ingestion and search
- Shipped Angular components and API specifications adopted company-wide
- Designed the hiring screen, conducted interviews, and ran the team's scrum
- Built lasting cross-org relationships — a networking background made Cisco's relationship-driven culture a natural fit

EARLIER ROLES

MultiView	Embedded corporate developer building award-winning B2B sites	2009 – 2012
Impremedia	Consolidated major newspaper publishers into a single digital CMS	2009 – 2012
Nexstar Broadcasting	Migrated 60+ TV stations to a multi-tenant CMS serving 1M+ daily	2005 – 2009
AT&T & Sprint	Telecom operations roles prior to moving into software engineering	2001 – 2005

LEADERSHIP & PRACTICES

- Lead by example, taking on the most complex or cross-cutting work
- Create open environments where blockers become shared responsibility
- Build consistent, narrow processes from design to deployment
- Launch rapid proofs of concept; build long runways for complex challenges
- Schema-backed system design: declare the model once, eliminate boilerplate, and accelerate development

INDEPENDENT & SIDE WORK

Storyboarder	Script-to-storyboard pipeline: OpenAI, Gemini, Veo, LTX-Video, Spark-TTS, Modal, Railway
Claude skill	Authored a published Claude skill for consistent, high-quality system designs
AI experiments	10+ AI-powered blogs, chat-bots, and n8n automation workflows; AI YouTube content
E-commerce	Built and launched drakomotors.com and hatsyshirtsy.com storefronts
WP-Advertise	WordPress ad-management plugin
Poker platform	Real-time multiplayer poker site
Client work	Engagements with Armory Agency and Lifeblue Studios